

PSYCH 260.001

Fall 2026

2026-07-14

The Neurological Bases of Human Behavior

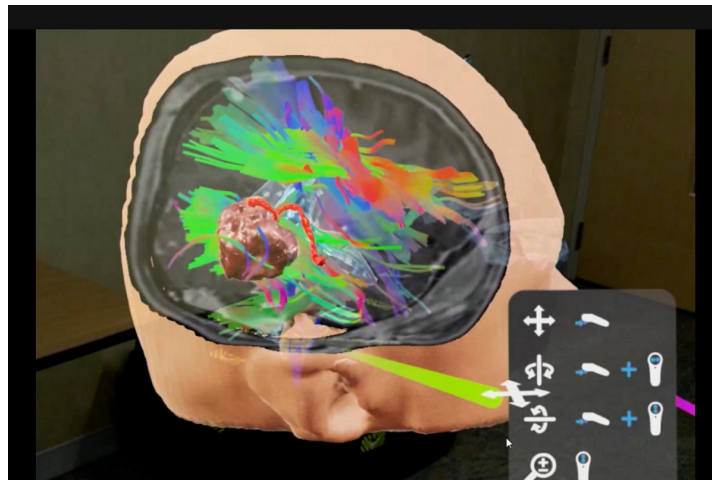


Figure 1: “A GPS for your mind” (2023)

Themes

There is no more fascinating or challenging field of inquiry than the nature, origin, structure, and functioning of the human mind and the behavior it enables. This course will examine human mental states and observable behaviors from a biological basis, especially focusing on the evolution, development, structure, and functioning of the nervous system.

i Note

Textbook reading assignments in the Watson & Breedlove text, *The Mind's Machine* will be indicated by the following shorthand: 'MM pp 3-15'. This means to read pages 3 to 15. Note that the text covers material we won't cover in class. If we don't cover material in class, you aren't responsible for it. That said, you may find it interesting to learn and know about anyway.

Week 01

Monday, August 24

`{r} sched_df$class_1_theme[1]`

- *Read:* MM pp 3-16
- *Slides:* | [html](#) |

Wednesday, August 26

`{r} sched_df$class_2_theme[1]`

- *Read:* MM pp 3-16
- *Watch:* National Geographic (2014), NeuroBriefs (2011), Eames Office (2010)
- *Slides:* | [html](#) |

Friday, August 28

Week 02

Monday, August 31, 2026

`{r} sched_df$class_1_theme[2]`

- *Read:* MM pp 44-50
- *Watch:* National Institute on Biomedical Imaging and Bioengineering (n.d.), Video (2010), Understanding Animal Research (2009)
- *Slides:* | [html](#) |

Wednesday, September 2

`{r} sched_df$class_2_theme[2]`

- *Read:* MM pp 27-44
- Extra credit assignment due: [Canvas dropbox](#)
- *Slides:* | [html](#) |

Friday, September 04

Week 03

Monday, September 07

NO CLASS: Labor Day

Wednesday, September 09

`{r} sched_df$class_1_theme[3]`

- *Read:* MM pp 16-27
- *Slides:* | [html](#) |

Friday, September 11

`{r} sched_df$class_2_theme[3]`

- *Slides:* | [html](#) |

Week 04

Monday, September 14

`{r} sched_df$class_1_theme[4]`

- *Read:* MM pp 20-27
- *Slides:* | [html](#) |

Wednesday, September 16

`{r} sched_df$class_2_theme[4]`

- *Read:* MM pp 58-74
- *Slides:* | [html](#) |

Friday, September 18

Week 05

Monday, September 21

`{r} sched_df$class_1_theme[5]`

- *Slides:* | [html](#) |

Wednesday, September 23

`{r} sched_df$class_2_theme[5]`

Friday, September 25

Week 06

Monday, September 28

`{r} sched_df$class_1_theme[6]`

- *Read:* MM pp 86-100
- *Slides:* | [html](#) |

Wednesday, September 30

`{r} sched_df$class_2_theme[6]`

Friday, October 02

Week 07

Monday, October 05

`{r} sched_df$class_1_theme[7]`

- *Read:* MM pp 102-106, 122-123
- *Slides:* | [html](#) |

Wednesday, October 07

`{r} sched_df$class_2_theme[7]`

- *Read:* MM pp 248-266
- *Slides:* | [html](#) |

Friday, October 09

Week 08

Monday, October 12

`{r} sched_df$class_1_theme[8]`

- *Slides:* | [html](#) |
- *Watch:* Scale: (2023)

Wednesday, October 14

`{r} sched_df$class_2_theme[8]`

- *Read:* MM pp 124-134, 145
- *Slides:* | [html](#) |

Friday, October 16

Week 09

Monday, October 19

`{r} sched_df$class_1_theme[9]`

- *Slides:* | [html](#) |

Wednesday, October 21

`{r} sched_df$class_2_theme[9]`

Friday, October 23

Week 10

Monday, October 26

`{r} sched_df$class_1_theme[10]`

- *Read:* MM pp 106-108, 412-405
- *Slides:* | [html](#) |

Wednesday, October 28

`{r} sched_df$class_2_theme[10]`

- *Read:* MM pp 106-108, 386-394
- *Slides:* | [html](#) |

Friday, October 30

Week 11

Monday, November 02

`{r} sched_df$class_1_theme[11]`

Wednesday, November 04

`{r} sched_df$class_2_theme[11]`

- *Read:* MM pp 356-369
- *Slides:* | [html](#) |

Friday, November 06

Week 12

Monday, November 09

`{r} sched_df$class_1_theme[12]`

- *Read:* MM pp 375-383
- *Slides:* | [html](#) |

Wednesday, November 11

`{r} sched_df$class_2_theme[12]`

- *Read:* MM pp 148-157
- *Slides:* | [html](#) |

Friday, November 13

Week 13

Monday, November 16

`{r} sched_df$class_1_theme[13]`

- *Slides:* | [html](#) |

Wednesday, November 18

`{r} sched_df$class_2_theme[13]`

- *Read:* MM pp 148-157
- *Slides:* | [html](#) |

Friday, November 20

Thanksgiving Break

NO CLASS

Week 14

Monday, November 30

~~Exam 3~~ (rescheduled for Thursday)

Wednesday, December 02

Exam 3

i Note

Slides and material for the following topic are provide here for students' reference.

Action II

- *Slides:* | [html](#) |

Friday, December 04

Week 15

Monday, December 07

{r} sched_df\$class_1_theme[16]

- *Slides:* | [html](#) |

Wednesday, December 09

{r} sched_df\$class_2_theme[16]

- *Slides:* | [html](#) |

Friday, December 11

Finals Week

Exam 4 (Final) TBD

References

- A GPS for your mind: Penn State Health's Brainlab surgical system helps teen recover from hemorrhage. (2023, October 30). Retrieved August 18, 2025, from <https://pennstatehealthnews.org/2023/10/a-gps-for-your-mind-penn-state-healths-brainlab-surgical-system-helps-teen-recover-from-hemorrhage/>
- Eames Office. (2010). *Powers of TenTM* (1977). YouTube. Retrieved from <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0fKBhvDjuy0>
- National Geographic. (2014, January). Beautiful 3-D brain scans show every synapse | national geographic. YouTube. Retrieved from <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nvXuq9jRWKE>
- National Institute on Biomedical Imaging and Bioengineering. (n.d.). *How does an MRI scan work?* YouTube. Retrieved from <https://www.youtube.com/embed/1CGzk-nV06g>
- NeuroBriefs. (2011). *The ascent: A brief history of the brain.* YouTube. Retrieved from <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=S0HKupSZq8k>
- Scale, T. (2023). *To scale: TIME.* YouTube. Retrieved from <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nOVvEbH2GC0>
- Understanding Animal Research. (2009). *Parkinson's disease.* YouTube. Retrieved from <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KDjWdtDyz5I>
- Video, N. (2010). *Method of the year 2010: Optogenetics - by nature video.* YouTube. Retrieved from <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=I64X7vHSHOE&list=PLRstm0n591-rBbOeC0SJey20-NwXpLo4G>